

James E. Kajdasz, Ph.D.

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SUMMARY

Senior Data Scientist specializing in fraud detection, identity risk, and adversarial behavior modeling, with 20+ years leading analytics and decision-support systems in high-stakes environments. Built large-scale fraud detection systems identifying over \$1B in fraudulent claims exposure across public-benefits programs, generating 100+ high-value investigative leads tied to synthetic identity fraud, mule networks, and coordinated fraud rings. Combines deep quantitative expertise in applied statistics, behavioral science, and intelligence analysis to solve high-impact fraud and risk problems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Machine Learning & Analytics: Fraud Detection, Identity Resolution, Entity Resolution, Feature Engineering, Risk Scoring, Graph Analytics, Link Analysis, Statistical Modeling, Logistic Regression, Classification, CNNs, Forecasting, Bayesian Analysis

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, boto3), Snowflake, GCP

Tools & Developer Workflow: Streamlit, Cytoscape, Git, VS Code, UV, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Conda

Modern AI: Agentic AI, RAG, LangChain, LangGraph, CrewAI, Vector Databases

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist — Thomson Reuters Special Services | 2022–Present

- Led fraud analytics strategy for a California public-benefits fraud engagement focused on unemployment insurance (UI), disability insurance (DI), and hospice fraud.
- Selected as the only data scientist retained across the full lifecycle of the engagement, which expanded from a 3-month proof-of-concept into a 3-year production contract.
- Developed over 100 high-value fraud leads contributing to identification of more than \$1B in fraudulent claims exposure.
- Architected and built PyEDD, an installable Python fraud analytics library (pip/conda) using object-oriented design and Git versioning.
- Designed and implemented Missing Man Analysis, a scalable address-linkage workflow identifying latent fraud operators hidden behind synthetic identities.
- Built graph-analysis pipelines and Cytoscape-ready node/edge datasets to uncover coordinated fraud rings.
- Built a Streamlit self-service analytics platform enabling non-technical analysts to search claims without SQL.

Machine Learning Engineer — Electromagnetic Systems, Inc. | 2020–2022

- Developed machine learning solutions for automatic target recognition (ATR) on large-scale government sensor imagery.
- Built ML workflows in AWS GovCloud using EC2, S3, and boto3.
- Performed hyperparameter tuning for CNN architectures to improve target-detection accuracy.
- Designed ETL pipelines to ingest, clean, normalize, and standardize heterogeneous imagery datasets.

Chief, Operations Assessment — U.S. Army Special Operations | Doha, Qatar | 2017

- Led operations assessment for U.S. information campaigns across ~9 countries focused on reducing support for ISIS.
- Developed psychometrically informed measurement frameworks and longitudinal scoring methods.
- Leveraged survey data to measure population attitudes and behavior over time.

Research Deputy Director & Assistant Professor — U.S. Air Force Academy | 2014–2018

- Served as Deputy Director of an Air Force-level R&D institute managing multidisciplinary teams.
- Served as AFRL liaison to USAFA's \$38M+ research enterprise.
- Evaluated \$30M in federal research proposals and supported research prioritization.
- Secured funding and led development of a \$500K UAS command-and-control center.

Faculty, Analytic Methodology & IRB Chair — National Intelligence University | 2010–2014

- Taught graduate and undergraduate courses to 700+ military and civilian intelligence professionals across DIA, NSA, and NGA.
- Taught structured analytic techniques, ACH, cognitive bias mitigation, forecasting, Bayesian reasoning, and signal detection.
- Chaired NIU's IRB, reviewing 400+ research proposals including classified research.
- Served as NIU representative to IARPA funding committees.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Quantitative Psychology — The Ohio State University

Master of Information and Data Science — UC Berkeley

M.A., Industrial & Organizational Psychology — George Mason University

B.S., Behavioral Sciences & Leadership — U.S. Air Force Academy

CERTIFICATIONS & ADVANCED TRAINING

Carnegie Mellon University — Agentic AI Program: Building Autonomous Systems for Real-World Applications Certificate Program

Certified Anti-Fraud Specialist (ACAMS)